

Day 35 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Local Government and Panchayat Raj

READING MATERIAL

Covers the evolution of Panchayati Raj through 4 key committees, and the 73rd Constitutional Amendment Act, 1992 (Part IX, Articles 243-243O) which gave Panchayats constitutional status. Real exam evidence is unusually precise about exact Article numbers and committee names — expect 'which committee recommended X' and 'which Article covers Y' formats.

Q: What did each of the four key Panchayati Raj committees specifically recommend — Balwantray Mehta, Ashok Mehta, G.V.K. Rao, and L.M. Singhvi?

A: Balwantray Mehta Committee (1957): recommended a 3-tier Panchayati Raj system (Gram Panchayat-village, Panchayat Samiti-block, Zila Parishad-district) — the original blueprint; Rajasthan adopted it first (1959). Ashok Mehta Committee (1977-78): recommended REPLACING the 3-tier with a 2-tier system (Zila Parishad + Mandal Panchayat) to revive a declining system — recommendation not widely adopted. G.V.K. Rao Committee (1985): reviewed rural development administration, called PRIs vital and recommended strengthening them. L.M. Singhvi Committee (1986): recommended PRIs be constitutionally recognised/entrenched, with the Gram Sabha as the base of decentralised democracy — this recommendation most directly led toward the 73rd Amendment.

Q: Real exam: Whose recommendation specifically initiated the move toward giving Panchayat Raj Institutions constitutional status?

A: The L.M. Singhvi Committee (1986) — confirmed by a real exam question, distinguishing it from the Ashok Mehta and Balwantray Mehta Committees offered as distractor options.

Q: What did the 73rd Constitutional Amendment Act, 1992 do, and when did it come into force?

A: It added Part IX (Articles 243-243O) to the Constitution, giving Panchayati Raj Institutions constitutional status — mandating a 3-tier system in every State, elections every 5 years, reservation of seats for SC/ST and women, and devolution of 29 subjects (Eleventh Schedule) to Panchayats. It received Presidential assent on 20 April 1993 and came into force on 24 April 1993 — commemorated since as National Panchayati Raj Day (24 April), confirmed by a real exam question.

Q: Real exam: Which Article of the Constitution introduced reservation of seats for SC/ST in Panchayats, and which Amendment is this part of?

A: Article 243D — part of the 73rd Constitutional Amendment, 1992 — confirmed by a real exam question.

Q: Real exam: Match Articles 243A, 243I, 243K, and 243O to their correct subjects.

A: Article 243A: Gram Sabha. Article 243I: constitution of the State Finance Commission (to review Panchayats' financial position). Article 243K: constitution of the State Election Commission (to conduct Panchayat elections). Article 243O: bar to interference by courts in Panchayat electoral matters — all four confirmed via a real exam's match-the-following question.

Q: What is the 74th Constitutional Amendment Act, and how does it relate to the 73rd?

A: Passed alongside the 73rd Amendment (1992), the 74th Amendment added Part IXA (Articles 243P-243ZG) to the Constitution, giving constitutional status to URBAN local bodies (Municipalities/Municipal Corporations) — the urban counterpart to the 73rd Amendment's rural Panchayats, with its own Twelfth Schedule of devolved subjects (distinct from Panchayats' Eleventh Schedule).

Q: Real exam: Which chapters of the Tamil Nadu Panchayats Act, 1994 deal with the Gram Sabha and Penalties, and which commonly-assumed pairing is actually FALSE?

A: Chapter II deals with the Gram Sabha; Chapter XII deals with Penalties — both confirmed TRUE by a real exam question. The same question tested 'Chapter VII deals with Taxation and Finance' as FALSE (Chapter VII covers a different subject in the actual Act) — a reminder not to assume sequential/intuitive chapter numbering matches reality.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. The Balwantray Mehta Committee (1957) recommended which structure for Panchayati Raj?

A. A 2-tier system

B. A 3-tier system: Gram Panchayat, Panchayat Samiti, Zila Parishad ✓

C. A single-tier village-only system

D. A 4-tier system including a national Panchayat body

Explanation: A 3-tier system. [medium, web-research]

2. Which Committee specifically initiated the recommendation for giving Panchayat Raj Institutions constitutional status?

A. G.V.K. Rao Committee

B. L.M. Singhvi Committee ✓

C. Ashok Mehta Committee

D. Balwantray Mehta Committee

Explanation: L.M. Singhvi Committee. [hard, question-bank-2017]

3. The 73rd Constitutional Amendment Act came into force on, which is now observed as National Panchayati Raj Day:

A. 26 January

B. 15 August

C. 24 April ✓

D. 2 October

Explanation: 24 April. [medium, question-bank-2026]

4. Reservation of seats for SC/ST in Panchayats was introduced by the 73rd Amendment under which Article?

A. Article 243A

B. Article 243D ✓

C. Article 243K

D. Article 243O

Explanation: Article 243D. [hard, question-bank-2026]

5. Which Article of the Constitution establishes the Gram Sabha?

A. Article 243A ✓

B. Article 243I

C. Article 243K

D. Article 243O

Explanation: Article 243A. [medium, question-bank-2026]

6. Which Article provides for the constitution of the State Election Commission to conduct Panchayat elections?

A. Article 243A

B. Article 243I

C. Article 243K ✓

D. Article 243O

Explanation: Article 243K. [hard, question-bank-2026]

7. The 74th Constitutional Amendment Act gave constitutional status to:

A. Panchayats (rural local bodies)

B. Municipalities (urban local bodies) ✓

C. The Union Public Service Commission

D. The Election Commission of India

Explanation: Municipalities (urban local bodies), via Part IXA. [medium, web-research]

8. Which Chapter of the Tamil Nadu Panchayats Act, 1994 deals with the Gram Sabha?

A. Chapter I

B. Chapter II ✓

C. Chapter VII

D. Chapter XII

Explanation: Chapter II. [hard, question-bank-2025]

9. Which Chapter of the Tamil Nadu Panchayats Act, 1994 deals with Penalties?

A. Chapter II

B. Chapter VII

C. Chapter X

D. Chapter XII ✓

Explanation: Chapter XII. [hard, question-bank-2025]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Highest Common Factor (HCF)

READING MATERIAL

HCF is 1 of 10 named Aptitude sub-skills. Real exam evidence (4 confirmed hits across 2022/2024/2025) shows TNPSC favors HCF *application* problems — measuring/tiling/container word problems and the HCF-LCM relationship — over plain 'find the HCF of these two numbers' questions, so the reading below leads with those application shapes.

Q: Real exam (2025): Two numbers are in the ratio 15:11. If their HCF is 13, find the numbers.

A: When two numbers are in a given ratio, write them as $15k$ and $11k$. Since $\text{HCF}(15,11)=1$ (the ratio is already in lowest terms), k IS the HCF — so $k=13$. The numbers are $15 \times 13=195$ and $11 \times 13=143$.

Q: Real exam (2025): What is the least number of square tiles needed to pave the ceiling of a room 15m 17cm long and 9m 2cm broad?

A: Convert to one unit: $1517 \text{ cm} \times 902 \text{ cm}$. The LARGEST square tile that exactly fits (no cutting) has a side equal to the HCF of the two dimensions. $\text{HCF}(1517, 902) = 41 \text{ cm}$ (via the Euclidean algorithm: $1517=1 \times 902+615$; $902=1 \times 615+287$; $615=2 \times 287+41$; $287=7 \times 41+0$). Tile area = $41 \times 41 = 1,681 \text{ cm}^2$. Room area = $1517 \times 902 = 1,368,334 \text{ cm}^2$. Number of tiles = $1,368,334 \div 1,681 = 814$.

Q: Real exam (2024): If the HCF of x^3-8y^3 and $x^2-k^2y^2$ is $x+ky$, find k .

A: Factor x^3-8y^3 using $a^3-b^3=(a-b)(a^2+ab+b^2)$ with $a=x$, $b=2y$: $x^3-8y^3 = (x-2y)(x^2+2xy+4y^2)$. Factor $x^2-k^2y^2$ using $a^2-b^2=(a-b)(a+b)$: $x^2-k^2y^2 = (x-ky)(x+ky)$. For ' $x+ky$ ' to be the common factor (HCF) of both, it must match one of the first expression's factors. $(x-2y)$ is the only linear factor available there, so $x+ky$ must equal $x-2y$, giving $k=-2$.

Q: Real exam (2022): What is the greatest possible volume of a vessel that can exactly measure the milk in cans of 80, 100, and 120 litres (each can measured to full capacity only)?

A: This is asking for the HCF of 80, 100, and 120. $\text{HCF}(80,100)=20$, then $\text{HCF}(20,120)=20$. So the answer is 20 litres — the largest vessel that can measure each can's full volume an exact whole number of times.

Q: Real exam (2022): The HCF and LCM of two numbers are 16 and 240 respectively. If one number is 48, find the other.

A: Use the relationship: $\text{HCF} \times \text{LCM} = \text{product of the two numbers}$. $16 \times 240 = 3,840$. Other number = $3,840 \div 48 = 80$.

Q: Method — finding HCF via the Euclidean algorithm (the fast way for large numbers): What is the HCF of 1517 and 902?

A: Repeatedly divide the larger by the smaller and replace the larger with the remainder, until the remainder is 0 — the last nonzero remainder is the HCF. $1517=1 \times 902+615 \rightarrow 902=1 \times 615+287 \rightarrow 615=2 \times 287+41 \rightarrow 287=7 \times 41+0$. $\text{HCF}=41$. This is the same calculation used in ro2 above — recognize it as the standard fast method rather than listing all factors of both numbers.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Two numbers are in the ratio 21:14. If their HCF is 12, find the larger number.

A. 36 ✓

B. 24

C. 252

D. 168

Explanation: Watch out: 21 and 14 are NOT coprime ($\text{gcd}=7$), so you can't directly multiply them by the HCF. Reduce the ratio first: $21:14 = 3:2$ (coprime). Now apply the HCF: larger = $3 \times 12=36$, smaller = $2 \times 12=24$. [hard, authored]

2. Find the largest square tile that can exactly pave a floor measuring 3m 8cm by 4m 20cm (no cutting).

A. 28 cm ✓

B. 14 cm

C. 56 cm

D. 84 cm

Explanation: Convert to cm: 308 and 420. $\text{HCF}(308,420)$: $420=1 \times 308+112$; $308=2 \times 112+84$; $112=1 \times 84+28$; $84=3 \times 28+0$. $\text{HCF}=28 \text{ cm}$. [hard, authored]

3. If the HCF of a^2-4b^2 and $a^2+ab-6b^2$ is $a-2b$, this is consistent with which factorization of the second expression?

A. $(a+3b)(a-2b)$ ✓

B. $(a-3b)(a+2b)$

C. $(a+3b)(a+2b)$

D. $(a-3b)(a-2b)$

Explanation: $a^2-4b^2=(a-2b)(a+2b)$. The second expression factors as $(a+3b)(a-2b) = a^2+ab-6b^2$ — sharing the common factor $(a-2b)$, so that's the HCF. [hard, authored]

4. What is the greatest volume that can exactly measure the contents of drums holding 72, 96, and 120 litres?

A. 12 litres

B. 24 litres ✓

C. 8 litres

D. 6 litres

Explanation: $\text{HCF}(72, 96) = 24$, then $\text{HCF}(24, 120) = 24$. Answer: 24 litres. [medium, authored]

5. The HCF and LCM of two numbers are 12 and 180 respectively. If one number is 36, find the other.

A. 48

B. 54

C. 60 ✓

D. 72

Explanation: $\text{HCF} \times \text{LCM} = 12 \times 180 = 2,160$. Other number = $2,160 \div 36 = 60$. [medium, authored]

6. Using the Euclidean algorithm, find the HCF of 1,073 and 925.

A. 37 ✓

B. 29

C. 31

D. 43

Explanation: $1073 = 1 \times 925 + 148$; $925 = 6 \times 148 + 37$; $148 = 4 \times 37 + 0$. $\text{HCF} = 37$. [medium, authored]

7. Two numbers are in the ratio 8:9 and their HCF is 7. Find their sum.

A. 105

B. 119 ✓

C. 126

D. 112

Explanation: Numbers: $8 \times 7 = 56$ and $9 \times 7 = 63$. Sum = $56 + 63 = 119$. [medium, authored]

Part C – General English: Prose: "Learning the Game" (Book Extract) — Sachin Tendulkar

READING MATERIAL

A first-person extract from Sachin Tendulkar's memoir, recounting how his brother Ajit introduced him (at age 11) to coach Ramakant Achrekar at Shardashram Vidyamandir, and the rigorous daily training that followed — including hardships like having only one set of cricket clothes and the now-famous 'one-rupee coin on the stumps' concentration drill.

Q: Who are 'the narrator' and the author of "Learning the Game", and which two cricketers did he admire and try to emulate?

A: The narrator IS the author — Sachin Tendulkar himself, in this first-person memoir extract. He admired and tried to emulate Sunil Gavaskar and Viv Richards.

Q: Which school did young Sachin initially attend, and who suggested he change schools, and to where?

A: He initially attended New English School. Coach Ramakant Achrekar suggested changing his school — to Shardashram Vidyamandir, where Achrekar himself coached cricket.

Q: Real exam: How old was Sachin when he first went to Achrekar's cricket camp, and who introduced him there?

A: 11 years old (confirmed by a real exam question, which also notes Achrekar himself started playing cricket at the same age). His elder brother Ajit introduced him to Achrekar.

Q: What was Achrekar's initial reaction to young Sachin's performance, and how did Ajit get him a second chance?

A: Achrekar initially suggested Ajit bring the boy back when he was OLDER (i.e., rejecting him at first). Ajit insisted Sachin deserved another chance because he knew Sachin could perform better — Achrekar agreed to watch again secretly (pretending to leave, observing from behind a tree/at a distance), and this time Sachin played confidently and was accepted into the camp.

Q: What was the daily training routine like during the summer camp, and what hardships did young Sachin endure?

A: TWO sessions a day — one in the morning and one in the evening, at Shivaji Park — with school squeezed in between. With only ONE set of cricket clothes, he had to wash and dry them between sessions; his pockets were often wet from the effort/perspiration of the rigorous training.

Q: What did Ajit discuss with Sachin during their bus journeys to and from practice, and what was Achrekar's famous concentration drill?

A: Ajit discussed the NUANCES OF BATTING with Sachin during their bus journeys. Achrekar's well-known drill: placing a one-rupee coin on top of the stumps during the last 15 minutes of net practice — whoever bowled Sachin out kept the coin, but if Sachin batted through unbowled, HE kept the coin — a method designed to build intense concentration and mental discipline.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. In "Learning the Game", the narrator is:

- A. A fictional cricketer
- B. Sachin Tendulkar himself (first-person memoir) ✓**
- C. Ramakant Achrekar
- D. Ajit Tendulkar

Explanation: Sachin Tendulkar himself. [easy, web-research]

2. Which two cricketers did the narrator admire and try to emulate?

- A. Kapil Dev and Sunil Gavaskar
- B. Sunil Gavaskar and Viv Richards ✓**
- C. Sachin Tendulkar and Kapil Dev
- D. Viv Richards and Kapil Dev

Explanation: Sunil Gavaskar and Viv Richards. [medium, web-research]

3. Who was the cricket coach at Shardashram Vidyamandir?

- A. Ramakant Achrekar ✓**
- B. Ajit Tendulkar
- C. Sunil Gavaskar
- D. Viv Richards

Explanation: Ramakant Achrekar. [easy, web-research]

4. How old was Sachin when he first went to Achrekar's cricket camp?

- A. 9 years old
- B. 10 years old
- C. 11 years old ✓**
- D. 12 years old

Explanation: 11 years old. [medium, question-bank-2022]

5. What did Achrekar initially suggest to Ajit regarding the narrator?

- A. To change his batting style
- B. To bring him back when he was older ✓**
- C. To focus on studies instead
- D. To join another coaching camp

Explanation: To bring him back when he was older. [medium, web-research]

6. What was the narrator's daily practice routine during the summer camp?

- A. One session in the morning only
- B. One session in the evening only
- C. Two sessions — morning and evening ✓**
- D. Two sessions — afternoon and evening

Explanation: Two sessions, morning and evening. [medium, web-research]

7. What did Ajit discuss with the narrator during their bus journeys?

- A. Schoolwork
- B. Bowling techniques
- C. The nuances of batting ✓**
- D. Fielding strategies

Explanation: The nuances of batting. [medium, web-research]

8. How did the narrator manage with only one set of cricket clothes during the camp?

- A. He borrowed clothes from friends
- B. He washed and dried them between sessions ✓**
- C. He bought extra clothes
- D. He wore them dirty every day

Explanation: He washed and dried them between sessions. [medium, web-research]

9. What was Achrekar's famous training drill to build the narrator's concentration?

- A. Placing a one-rupee coin on the stumps during the last 15 minutes of practice ✓**
- B. Making him bat blindfolded
- C. Having him practise alone at night
- D. Rewarding him with sweets for every run scored

Explanation: Placing a one-rupee coin on the stumps. [hard, web-research]

10. What did Achrekar suggest for the narrator to improve his cricket, regarding his education?

- A. Changing his school ✓**
- B. Playing more matches
- C. Focusing only on studies
- D. Attending more camps abroad

Explanation: Changing his school (to Shardashram Vidyamandir). [medium, web-research]